

severity level determines to which entity to attribute a particular system log. The level determines the importance or severity of the system log. These two parameters allow the system to decide when a particular action must be logged and what action must be taken.

Since nearly every action in FreeBSD generates a log file, and every log file takes up some amount of space, it can be easy for all your system space to fill up exclusively through log files. To resolve this issue, FreeBSD contains a built-in program known as `newsyslog`. This program is used to periodically compress old log files generated by a system logging program. Once these files have been compressed and moved, the program also informs the application that generated the log file.

Remote logging is another really important application that can be utilised in FreeBSD. Given that logging can become unwieldy and heavy if multiple hosts are involved, remote logging helps you set up a centralised logging system where all logging activity takes place.

Configuration files

The configuration files in FreeBSD are generally kept in a handful of different directories. Since these directories are generally fixed, they can be read during startup specifically, which is much easier than scanning the whole system for configuration files. The following are the primary directories where configuration files are included in FreeBSD.

- **/etc:** This directory includes generic configuration files that contain information regarding the system.
- **/etc/defaults:** All system configuration files contain default versions that are run in case the files are not modified elsewhere. These default versions are included in the Defaults directory.
- **/etc/mail:** The mail directory contains several MTA configuration files, including `sendmail(8)` configuration files.
- **/etc/ppp:** The ppp directory includes configuration files for ppp programs of both the user and the kernel.
- **/usr/local/etc:** This directory contains configuration files for applications that have been installed externally. Applications themselves may create subsidiaries to store additional files.
- **/usr/local/etc/rc.d:** This directory contains `rc(8)` scripts for applications that have been installed externally.
- **/var/db:** This directory contains database files associated with the system, like the `locate` database or the package database.